



The Computer Programmer

By Anna Kirschberg



Book Summary

This non-fiction book looks at the history of computer programming and Ada Lovelace, with vibrant, diverse and modern photography. Features of the Book – Phase 6 - Fluent. Suffixes are reviewed.

This book follows the Beanstalk Books (Letters & Sounds) Phase 6 progression and focuses on teaching spelling patterns, affixes and building to a fluency level.

Skills and Strategies

This book builds on decodable reading strategies for high/low readers. The book has been written with rich vocabulary including embedded words that contain suffixes and prefixes.

Phase 6 - Affixes

-s and -es	-ing	-ed
-er	-est	un-

Discuss the use of affixes for changing the meaning of words and the spelling rules that can be applied. The text of this book consolidates earlier taught phonics skills and revision of tricky common exception words.

Affixes:

-s / -es: computers, sets, instructions, calculations, poets, notes, patterns, codes, inspires, interests

-ing: programming

-ed: considered, existed, started, designed, called, detailed, published, republished, loved*, deserved*, encouraged*, acknowledged*

-er: programmer

-est: greatest

**Drop e and add suffix*

This book also supports other key reading strategies:

- Recognising the relationship between words and images;
- Pointing one-to-one at each word to ensure an appropriate match;
- Vocabulary and word study.

This book also supports key comprehension strategies:

- Making connections between prior knowledge and the text;
- Summarising the main ideas.

This book also supports non-fiction strategies:

- Gaining information from photographs;
- Encountering curriculum related terms and concepts.

Introducing the Text

Open up the discussion about the front cover image and make connections with the children's prior knowledge of this topic. Prompt discussions by using the vocabulary in the book.

What does the title of the book tell you about the front cover image?

What do you already know about this topic?

Read the title and the name of the author to the group. Read aloud the examples of words with affixes added to them and any spelling rules that apply, from the front inner cover.

Reading the Text

Pages 2 and 3 – Explain where to begin reading, and ask the student to point to each word as you read aloud together. What do you know about the history of computer programming? Have you ever heard of Ada Lovelace before?

Pages 4 and 5 – In this photograph, describe what you can see in the images and review the text together. Identify the words in the text that feature the use of the Phase 6 suffixes notated.

Pages 6 and 7 – Here, the reader will encounter some new words. Can you think of any words that contain suffix -ing, and can you find other examples in the text? What spelling rules apply to these words when adding an affix?

Page 8 – Describe what the photograph on the final page is showing. Which words contain the -ing or the -s suffix?

Children can now read the book independently. At the end of the book, go over the text and photographs again and discuss what is happening on each page.

Revisiting the Text

As a group, begin to discuss the use of suffixes for changing the meaning of words and some of the spelling rules that may be applied. Refer back to the table in the front inner cover. For example, the word 'great' changes to 'greatest' when the -est suffix is applied. Discuss how the meaning of the word changes here, as well as any spelling rules used.

Review the affix word examples on the front inner cover and discuss their meanings, and how they relate to the text.

Following Up

Use the BLM for this story, the students can learn more about the use of affixes and spelling strategies.